

CitiSense: SWPS University's Role and Questions for the Kick-off

Briefing note for the kick-off meeting, Florence, 27–29 October 2026

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1. Purpose

This note sets out how we at SWPS University understand our part in CitiSense, and lists the questions we would like to settle at the kick-off. Where our reading of the Grant Agreement differs from the coordinator's or from CEU's, we would be grateful to be corrected: the point is to agree a shared understanding before WP6 begins in April 2027.

Sixteen questions follow in Section 6. Four matter most, because their answers shape the WP6 work plan or face an early deadline:

- **Q1.** Is SWPS the sole lead of WP6, or its co-lead with CEU?
- **Q2.** Who drafts each of the four WP6 deliverables?
- **Q5.** Which survey data will Task 6.3 use for Poland and Hungary, which the WP2 survey does not cover?
- **Q6.** Can WP6 add a short block of questions to the WP2 survey? Survey design (T2.1) closes at M6 (March 2027).

2. SWPS in CitiSense at a glance

Role	Beneficiary 12 (USWPS); lead beneficiary of WP6, Economic Dimensions of Enlargement
Team	Ben Stanley (principal investigator), Marta Żerkowska-Balas
Effort	13 person-months: WP6 10; WP2 1; WP10 1; WP11 0.5; WP12 0.5
By person	Ben Stanley 8 person-months (WP6 6; WP2, WP10, WP11 and WP12 0.5 each); Marta Żerkowska-Balas 5 person-months (WP6 4; WP2 and WP10 0.5 each)
Leads	WP6 (M7–M24); Tasks 6.3 and 6.4; Deliverables D6.2 and D6.3
Partner in	T6.1 and T6.2; the WP2 pilot survey (T2.2); WP10 Tasks 10.1–10.4; the WP11 tasks that name all partners; WP12 (Steering Committee, data management, quality assurance)

Table 1. SWPS University's role in CitiSense

3. Work Package 6: our understanding

WP6 runs from M7 to M24 (April 2027 – September 2028), with 30 person-months across five partners: CEU 12.5, SWPS 10, ISU 3, UKMA 3 and IPRE 1.5. Its objectives are to analyse the economic costs and benefits of enlargement and non-enlargement; to draw political-economic lessons from previous enlargements; to assess the long-term relationship between post-accession economic development and political attitudes and behaviour; to examine subnational variation in the governance of EU funds; and to turn these findings into adaptive policy recommendations.

Task	Title	Lead	Partners	Months	Feeds
T6.1	Literature review	CEU	SWPS	M7–M18	D6.1
T6.2	Inclusion and exclusion at the regional level	CEU	SWPS, ISU, UKMA	M13–M24	D6.2
T6.3	Perceptions, attitudes and behaviour	SWPS	CEU, ISU, UKMA, IPRE	M13–M24	D6.3
T6.4	Policy recommendations	SWPS	CEU, ISU, UKMA	M7–M24	D6.4

Table 2. WP6 tasks (Annex 1, Part A)

No.	Deliverable	Lead	Due
D6.1	Policy Paper: Ambiguities in Economic Cost-Benefit Analysis	CEU	M24
D6.2	Policy Paper: Patterns of Regional Exclusion and Inclusion	SWPS	M24
D6.3	Research Report: Popular Perceptions of Socio-Economic Developments	SWPS	M24
D6.4	Policy Paper: Adaptive Approaches to Economic Integration and Enlargement	CEU	M24

Table 3. WP6 deliverables; all are public and due in September 2028

3.1. Three features of the structure

Task and deliverable leads cross over. T6.2 is led by CEU but feeds D6.2, which SWPS leads; T6.4 is led by SWPS but feeds D6.4, which CEU leads. This may be a deliberate split between research and writing, or a remnant of the proposal’s drafting. Either way, WP6 needs an explicit agreement on who drafts each deliverable (Q2).

Everything lands at M24. All four deliverables are due in September 2028, the same month as the second cross-WP workshop. They need an internal timetable that works back from that date (Q4).

Leadership is described in two ways. Part A names SWPS as the lead beneficiary of WP6. Part B describes WP6 as co-led by László Bruszt (CEU) and Ben Stanley (SWPS), and CEU holds the larger share of the effort. Both descriptions can be true at once, but the division of responsibilities should be explicit (Q1).

3.2. Data

T6.3 and D6.3 focus on Hungary and Poland. The two lead institutions have already prepared national inventories of the public opinion data available for this analysis:

- **Poland (SWPS, September 2026):** the CBOS monthly survey *Aktualne problemy i wydarzenia* (329 waves archived for 1990–2017; the series continues) and the European Social Survey (every round). The Polish National Election Study (PGSW), the Polish Panel Survey (POLPAN) and Diagnoza Społeczna cover questions that these two cannot. Both main Polish datasets carry a regional identifier at NUTS 2 level.
- **Hungary (CEU, Krisztina Szabó, August 2026):** the TÁRKI Omnibusz (1997–2017) and the European Social Survey. The TÁRKI data identify settlement type but not region.

The WP2 survey covers five member states (Estonia, Slovenia, France, the Netherlands, Spain) and four candidate countries (Ukraine, Moldova, North Macedonia, Serbia), but neither Poland nor Hungary. Part B nonetheless expects T6.3 to use survey data “including from WPs 2 and 3”. Questions 5–7 address this.

For T6.2, SWPS will cover Poland: regional data on EU fund allocations and payments, and socio-economic series at NUTS 2 and NUTS 3 level (Eurostat, ARDECO, Statistics Poland). CEU covers Hungary and the fieldwork in two Ukrainian regions.

3.3. How we propose to run WP6

We will bring the following proposal to the kick-off for discussion with CEU and the other WP6 partners:

1. A WP6 meeting of all five partners at the kick-off or shortly afterwards.
2. A written division of labour, by task and by deliverable, agreed by the end of November 2026.
3. An internal timetable for the deliverables: drafts at M21 (June 2028); partner and Advisory Board review at M22 (July 2028); revisions and the quality note required under T12.4 at M23 (August 2028); submission at M24 (September 2028).
4. WP6 calls every six to eight weeks from M7, and a shared workspace.
5. Agreed rules on authorship of journal articles that draw on WP6 work.

4. SWPS's contributions to other work packages

Work package (lead)	SWPS role	Months	Effort
WP2 Public opinion survey (SU)	Partner in the pilot survey (T2.2, all partners). SWPS is not a partner in survey design (T2.1).	M6–M10	1 PM
WP10 Toolboxes (UDE)	Named partner in the toolbox for policymakers (T10.1), the Youth Labs (T10.3; Warsaw is one of 14 cities) and the “Europe Next” country reports (T10.4); all partners contribute to the civil society and education toolbox (T10.2)	M12–M36	1 PM
WP11 Communication (TEPSA)	Tasks naming all partners: external communication (T11.1), Expert Hub (T11.2), public panels (T11.3), policy briefs (T11.5), national briefings (T11.6), traditional media (T11.10), participatory videos (T11.12)	M1–M36	0.5 PM
WP12 Management (EUI)	Steering Committee member as WP6 lead (T12.5); input to the Data Management Plan (T12.2), quality assurance (T12.4) and reporting (T12.3)	M1–M36	0.5 PM
WP13 Ethics (EUI)	Input to the ethics report (D13.1)	M18	–

Table 4. SWPS contributions outside WP6

5. Key dates for SWPS

Month	Date	Event
M1	Oct 2026	Kick-off, Florence (Milestone 2, scheduled in the Grant Agreement for M3)
M3	Dec 2026	First Advisory Board and Civil Society Network consultation
M6	Mar 2027	Conceptual framework (D1.1); Data Management Plan (D12.2); survey design (T2.1) closes
M6–M10	Mar–Jul 2027	WP2 pilot survey (T2.2)
M7	Apr 2027	WP6 begins with T6.1 and T6.4
M10–M16	Jul 2027 – Jan 2028	WP2 fieldwork
M13	Oct 2027	T6.2 and T6.3 begin
M18	Mar 2028	Mid-term conference; first cross-WP workshop; second AB and CSN consultation; first EC review; WP2 survey data (D2.1); ethics report (D13.1)
M24	Sep 2028	WP6 deliverables D6.1–D6.4; second cross-WP workshop
M30	Mar 2029	Third AB and CSN consultation
M32	May 2029	Toolbox for policymakers (D10.1); Youth Labs report (D10.3)
M36	Sep 2029	Final conference, Brussels; third cross-WP workshop; second EC review

Table 5. Project dates that involve SWPS (M1 = October 2026)

6. Questions for the kick-off

A. Leading WP6

Q1. Is SWPS the sole lead of WP6, or its co-lead with CEU? (*Priority.*) Part A of Annex 1 names SWPS as the lead beneficiary; Part B describes WP6 as co-led by László Bruszt and Ben Stanley. *Our proposal:* SWPS takes the formal lead role (the Steering Committee seat, coordination and WP-level reporting), and scientific direction is shared with CEU. Does this match the coordinator's and CEU's understanding?

Q2. Who drafts each WP6 deliverable? (*Priority.*) T6.2 (CEU) feeds D6.2 (SWPS), and T6.4 (SWPS) feeds D6.4 (CEU). *Our proposal:* for D6.2, CEU drafts the Hungarian and Ukrainian material, SWPS drafts the Polish and comparative material, and SWPS edits the whole; for D6.4, CEU drafts from the recommendations developed in T6.4 under SWPS's coordination. We would welcome CEU's view.

Q3. What will ISU, UKMA and IPRE contribute? Their effort is 3, 3 and 1.5 person-months. T6.3 focuses on Hungary and Poland, yet names all three as partners. Is the intention a comparison with candidate countries (for example, expectations of the economic effects of accession), or input to the recommendations? And who carries out the T6.2 fieldwork in two Ukrainian regions?

Q4. Is there a project-wide review schedule for deliverables? Section 3.3 proposes an internal timetable for WP6. We would like it to fit whatever schedule EUI and UM plan for the quality notes required under T12.4.

B. Data for WP6

Q5. Which survey data will T6.3 use for Poland and Hungary? (*Priority.*) The WP2 survey does not cover either country. We plan to base the long-run analysis on the national and cross-national data described in Section 3.2, and to use WP2 data for cross-national comparison of economic perceptions where the questions allow. Is this acceptable to the coordinator and to SU? Is adding Poland and Hungary to the WP2 survey feasible at all?

Q6. Can WP6 add a short block of questions to the WP2 survey? (*Priority.*) The proposal draft for this work package included a short block of retrospective and prospective evaluations of personal, local and national economic conditions. That block did not survive into the final Annex 1. SWPS is not a partner in T2.1, which closes at M6 (March 2027). Is there room for such a block, and what are the route and deadline for proposing it?

Q7. When can WP6 partners use the WP2 data? The public dataset (D2.1) is due at M18 (March 2028), and T6.3 runs from M13 to M24. Could WP6 have access once fieldwork ends at M16, and on what terms?

Q8. Is anyone relying on an SWPS survey panel? Part B lists SWPS alongside SU as providing access to nationally representative survey panels. Annex 1 plans no survey fieldwork at SWPS and none is budgeted. We raise this only so that no work package plans on an SWPS survey.

C. Links to the rest of the project

Q9. What does WP1 need from WP6, and when? The conceptual and methodological framework (D1.1) is due at M6, before WP6 begins. How will it define the economic costs and benefits of enlargement and non-enlargement, and would WP1 like WP6 input before M6?

Q10. When can the WP6 recommendations be validated? T6.4 requires validation with the Civil Society Network (T10.5) and the Expert Hub (T11.2). Our draft recommendations should be ready around M21–M22 (June–July 2028). Can those sessions be scheduled now? Could the M18 consultation test an early version?

Q11. What is expected of SWPS in the Youth Labs and “Europe Next”? Warsaw is one of the 14 Youth Lab cities (T10.3). Who organises the Warsaw lab, and what is SWPS’s part in it? For the “Europe Next” country reports (T10.4), are partners expected to suggest topics, supervise a report, or provide data?

Q12. When and in what format should the national briefing take place? Under T11.6 each partner organises a briefing with national policymakers. Should the Polish briefing follow the M24 recommendations, and what format does TEPSA expect?

D. Data management, ethics and publication

Q13. What does EUI need from partners for the Data Management Plan? Part B foresees a first draft for the kick-off, and D12.2 is due at M6. In what form, and by when, should partners describe their datasets?

Q14. Does WP6 work at SWPS need ethics approval? Our understanding is that it does not: the work is secondary analysis of anonymised survey data and aggregate regional statistics, which Part B treats as raising no ethical issues. Is this consistent with EUI’s approach to the Ethics Monitoring Protocol and the ethics report (D13.1)?

Q15. Will the consortium agree a publication policy? We would welcome shared rules on authorship, internal review before journal submission, open-access routes and repositories, and on publishing material from deliverables in journals.

E. Governance

Q16. When and how will the Steering Committee and the cross-WP workshops meet? What is the schedule of Steering Committee meetings and six-monthly risk reviews, and which of these meetings and the cross-WP workshops (M18, M24, M36) will be held in person rather than online? This helps us plan who from SWPS attends which meeting. Does the Steering Committee want WP6 input before WP6 formally begins at M7, for example for the M3 consultation?